



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Bear Creek School

School Website: <https://tbcs.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**SCL MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

### Executive Summary

Bear Creek School (WA 98053) presents a clear and well-articulated classical Christian orientation. Public-facing materials consistently frame the school as a Christian liberal arts institution that embraces a classical pedagogy (notably the trivium) and a formation-focused mission. The public materials emphasize virtue, wisdom, and courage, a Christian worldview, and family partnerships, with explicit references to imago Dei and in loco parentis as foundational commitments. While the school strongly signals classical aims in curriculum and mission, some elements typically associated with a fully classical model (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation programming, pervasive Socratic seminars at the upper levels, and broad history-as-history rather than social-studies framing) are less explicit in the materials reviewed from Bear Creek's site crawl. Overall, the school leans CLASSICAL, with some categories demonstrating stronger classical alignment than others.

- Evidence of classical and religious foundations is robust (Christian identity, virtue formation, theological framing, the trivium, liberal arts).
- Public materials emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and God-intended persons, not mere job preparation.
- Clear commitment to parental partnership and community life is present (imago Dei, in loco parentis, parent partnership).
- Some classical elements (e.g., Great Books/Great Conversation, explicit upper-school Socratic pedagogy) are not clearly evidenced in the crawl; those areas are flagged as somewhat classical.

#### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Notes on how the six-category rubric was applied: - Element 1, 2, 5, and 6 show strong alignment with classical, Christian formation and community practices, including explicit theological framing, virtue cultivation, and tight-knit faculty/community emphasis. - Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) show clear classical markers (e.g., trivium, liberal arts, teacher-student formation), but some hallmark elements (extensive Great Books/Great Conversation programming, explicit Socratic seminar culture in upper grades, and explicit historical curriculum framing throughout the program) are less directly evidenced in the crawl. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation for these two categories, and a move toward CLASSICAL would require additional explicit textual signals in those areas.

What would move the needle - Element 3 (Curriculum): Add explicit Great Books/Great Conversation components and a clearly stated history-integration across disciplines (not framed as social studies). Include language about cultivation and experience of wonder as part of daily learning. - Element 4 (Pedagogy): Document and publicize explicit Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates in upper grades, with a visible rhetoric-skills program (speeches, debates) to match the classical pedagogy model. - Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): Consider weaving explicit liturgical or communal prayer/worship rhythms into daily/weekly schedules and demonstrating how these practices shape character formation in direct alignment with transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and the Logos-based framework.

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## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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